

Sacramento Roller Derby Junior Program

★ About Our Program ★

The Beastie Bears are the Sacramento Roller Derby Junior Program skaters. We are an open gender program and skaters range in age from 8-17 (skaters may be 18 if they are 17 at the beginning of the JRDA season on Sept 1). The Beastie Bears are a [Junior Roller Derby Association \(JRDA\)](#) member league.

We have two teams in our Beastie Bear program - Sabotage and Intergalactic. Sabotage is our charter team that competes in sanctioned games, tournaments, and post season play. Intergalactic is our development and recreation team that fosters a fun and competitive environment to build the skills skaters need to be ready for higher level play.

Our Training program builds the foundational skills needed to play roller derby. The Derby 101 program is a beginner level program open to all youth and does not require any prior skills. It focuses on basic skating skills, safety, and introduces roller derby concepts. The Derby 201 program is by invitation only and requires completion of Derby 101 (skaters typically complete several iterations of Derby 10 before moving up). It focuses on learning roller derby game play and full contact to prepare for joining the Intergalactic team.

The pathway: Ursa Minor → Ursa Major → Blast Off Bears graduates feed into Intergalactic (recreational team) → skaters progress from Intergalactic into Sabotage (charter/competitive team).

★ Meet Our Team ★

Coaches are assigned to specific programs to drive their goals and strategy, but all coaches work with all skaters during practices for diversity in perspective and learning. All coaches meet JRDA volunteer requirements to work with youth programs including background checks, SafeSport certification, first aid/CPR certification, and concussion training.

Coach Bull Doze-Her (Bull)

Melissa Wilcox (they/she)
Junior Program Head Coach

Bull has been with SRD since 2019, they have been a skater with Kodiak Attack, an official (on and off skates), and now focus on running the Junior Beastie Bears program. They have been a coach with the junior program since 2023 and they are passionate about sports that celebrate all body types where every type has its own strength. Their favorite skill to teach is endurance, not only is it a foundational building block of derby, it teaches confidence and resilience in being able to push yourself far.

Coach Billie the Squid (Squid)

Abby Pratt (she/her)

Sabotage Head Coach

Squid started roller derby in 2018, playing in Louisiana, Illinois, and Missouri before transferring to SRD in 2024. While she loves playing herself, coaching is where she really finds her derby joy. She strives to create a safe space where kids of all ages can be themselves and find their confidence. Her favorite skill to teach is strategy because she gets to watch skaters have that aha moment and see the magic happen!

Coach Quista (Qui or Qui Qui)

Paula Levitt (she/her)

Sabotage Coach

Coach Lazer Wolf (Lazer)

Justin Emery (he/him)

Intergalactic Head Coach

Coach Braveheart

Zevi Lev Horwitz (he/him)

101/201 Program Head Coach

Coach Reign of Tara (Tara)

Tara Swick (she/her)

Intergalactic & 101/201 Program Coach

Tara has been involved with SRD since her first 101 in 2023 and now plays with the Kodiak's. She started coaching the Beastie Bears and assisting the junior 101 program in 2024. She believes every great skater starts with a solid foundation and her favorite skill to teach is **balance** — the essential "secret sauce" for staying upright, agile, and powerful on eight wheels.

BamBOO

Michelle Ng (she/her)

101/201 Program Coach